

Miquel Barba

CTO & Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Hands-on CTO and 3x founder who builds from zero and scales. 25+ years writing code and 14+ years leading engineering teams. Co-founded TitanOS in 2023, raised €50M Series A, and grew it to 150 engineers powering 5M+ smart TVs across Europe in under three years. Currently leading the org's shift to AI-driven development — practices, agents, and tooling. Previously scaled Rakuten TV's backend to billions of requests per month across 27 markets, and co-founded a mobile email startup before the iPhone. Equally comfortable shipping the first commit, hiring the first 10 engineers, or sitting with the CEO on roadmap and fundraising.

SKILLS

Claude Code | AI tooling | Ruby & Ruby on Rails | Javascript & React & Cypress | Go & Gin & Gorm | React Native | Java & J2EE | Elixir | Python | Amazon Web Services | Docker | MySQL | PostgreSQL | Redis | ElasticSearch | Git | Continuous integration | Continuous deployment | Agile methodologies | Startups & entrepreneurship | People management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CTO & Co-founder — Titan OS

Apr 2023 – Present

Barcelona, Spain

- Co-founded TitanOS, a Smart TV operating system. Raised €50M Series A. Shipped on 5M+ TVs across Europe and Latam, through OEM partnerships with Philips, JVC, and Sharp.
- Wrote the first commit, made early architecture decisions, and shipped the first version end-to-end.
- Scaled the team from a small founding group to 150 engineers across firmware, backend, frontend, infrastructure, and QA.
- Built the engineering culture from day one: ownership, KPIs, CI/CD, automated testing, code review, Scrum.
- Leading the org-wide shift to AI-driven development: rolled out Claude Code, defined agent-assisted coding practices, and built internal agents and tooling to lift shipping velocity.
- Structured the org into teams and managers as it grew; hire, coach, and grow engineering leaders.
- Own the annual infrastructure and tooling budget; partner with the CEO and CFO on headcount planning and quarterly forecasting across a 150-engineer org.
- Partner directly with the CEO and Product on roadmap, estimates, risk, and board-level updates.

CTO & Founder — Instant API

Oct 2021 – Apr 2023

Barcelona, Spain

- Built and shipped a serverless platform to create APIs end-to-end (Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, AWS, Docker, ES6, React). Wound down after the product did not find market fit.

CTO — Rakuten TV

May 2017 – Oct 2021

Barcelona, Spain

- Led engineering for the European leader in VOD & AVOD, with the Rakuten TV app on millions of TVs and devices.
- Managed a 60-person org across backend, playback, TV devices, mobile, web, and QA.
- Established the engineering culture: KPIs and objectives, ownership, technical-debt management, code review, automated testing, CI, and Scrum.
- Worked with the CEO and Product team on roadmap, estimates, risk, and deadlines.
- Owned people management end-to-end: recruiting, team building, performance reviews, raises, performance management, and conflict resolution.

Backend Team Manager — Rakuten TV

May 2011 – May 2017

Barcelona, Spain

- Designed and led the core API serving billions of monthly requests across 27 European markets and millions of devices.
- Stack: Ruby on Rails, Sidekiq, AWS, MySQL, Elasticsearch, Redis, Varnish, Docker.
- Managed a team of 15 Ruby on Rails engineers.

CTO & Co-Founder — Mobiquus

Oct 2007 – May 2011

Barcelona, Spain

- Built a real-time email push service supporting 200+ devices, from feature phones to smartphones — pre-iPhone era.
- Shipped features including voicemail and previews for Office documents, images, video, and audio.
- Owned the full product lifecycle: functional definition, architecture, development, and testing.

Software Engineer (Java/J2EE) — INPS (In Practice Systems Ltd)

Nov 2006 – Oct 2007

London, UK

Software Architect — Tempos 21

Sep 2002 – Nov 2006

Barcelona, Spain — Joint venture of Telefónica Móviles, Ericsson, and HP

- Delivered messaging (SMS/EMS/WAP Push), MMS, and location-based services on Java/J2EE and Oracle.

Earlier engineering roles (1998 – 2002) — Barcelona, Spain

- Gedas (contractor) — Software Engineer, Java/J2EE & Oracle. Mar 2002 – Sep 2002.
- GFT (contractor) — Software Engineer, Java/J2EE & Oracle. Dec 2000 – Mar 2002.
- Sopra Steria — Software Engineer, Java/J2EE. Feb 2000 – Dec 2000.
- Grupo En Efecto — Developer. Jan 1999 – Feb 2000.
- Sage Spain — Intern. Feb 1998 – Sep 1998.

EDUCATION

Engineer, Computer Science

Jun 1999

Facultat d'Informàtica de Barcelona — Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya

LANGUAGES

English, Spanish, Catalan